9.11 Rheumatoid Arthritis

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • "My hand joints are swollen and stiff for hours in the morning." **Objective** • Same joints swollen on both sides • ESR raised • Stiff for more than 1 hour in the morning	**ACTUAL** **Chronic pain** related to joint inflammation as evidenced by swollen painful joints.	Says pain and stiffness are less.	• Give DMARDs and anti-inflammatory drugs as prescribed. • A warm shower in the morning helps. • Balance rest with exercise.	Less pain: **goal met**.
Subjective • "I cannot button my shirt." **Objective** • Hands deformed • Takes 30 minutes to get dressed	**ACTUAL** **Dressing self-care deficit** related to joint deformity as evidenced by inability to fasten buttons.	Gets dressed using adaptive aids.	• Refer to occupational therapy. • Suggest Velcro fastenings and adapted clothes.	Dresses herself: **goal met**.
Subjective • *No specific complaint* **Objective** • On immunosuppressive drugs • WBC low	**RISK** **Risk for infection** as evidenced by risk factors: immunosuppressive therapy.	No infection.	• Follow blood counts as ordered. • Teach her to report fever. • Check her vaccinations.	No infection: **goal met**.